

Prakul Sherikar

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EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Austin | Expected May 2028

Bachelor of Science in Mechanical Engineering

GPA: 3.74/4.00

- *Activities:* Longhorn Baja Racing SAE (Front Upright Lead), Longhorn Simracing (Competition Officer), IEEE RAS, UT ASME, UT Club Tennis
- *Relevant Coursework:* Advanced Calculus II, Differential Equations with Linear Algebra, Dynamics, Mechanics of Solids, Combustion Engine Processes, Fluid Mechanics & Lab (in progress), and Materials Engineering & Lab (in progress)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Cad & Modeling: Solidworks, Fusion 360
- Simulation & Analysis: Ansys Fluent, CFD, Telemetry/Data analysis
- Programming & Software: MATLAB, Python
- Manufacturing & Testing: 3D Printing, Rapid Prototyping

PROJECTS & EXPERIENCES

Longhorn Baja SAE | Front Upright Design Lead | September 2025 - Present

- Designed front upright geometry and structural layout using SolidWorks for an off-road racing vehicle
- Reduced unsprung mass by 54% (4+ lbs to 1.85 lbs) through targeted pocketing and material selection while maintaining steering and suspension kinematics
- Conducted structural validation by executing FEA within Ansys to simulate worst-case loads, including a 6,400 N vertical load during steering-bump interactions and 4,800 N braking frictional forces
- Collaborated cross-functionally with 4 mechanical subsystems to optimize vehicle packaging and performance

IEEE RAS - Chessbot

- Designed and implemented a CoreXY-based robotic system in our AI-powered chess robot that moves pieces based on player input.
- Utilized CAD to model and 3D print key components of the mechanical system, including the electromagnet case.

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

Longhorn Sim Racing | Competition Officer & Driver | May 2026 - Present

- Managed competition team's events, practice data, and initial fuel/pit strategy
- Scaled the "Lone Star Cup" racing league from a localized campus grid into a competitive multi-collegiate league featuring drivers from Clemson and Texas State

SCCA F&C Marshal | F&C Marshal for FIA/COTA | 2025 - Present

- Served as Flagging & Communication Marshal for elite international motorsports series including FIA WEC (Lonestar Lemans) and SVRA Trans Am
- Manage live corner/sector safety signaling, track condition communication, and incident response in high-intensity, fast-paced environments

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- VEX Robotics: Qualified for international Competition (State "Think Award" for Autonomous Coding); Destination Imagination Global Finalist (Placed 20th internationally Da Vinci Award)
- Interests: Autonomous Robotics, Aerodynamics, Motorsports, and Coffee Brewing (Love Iced Coffee)